

Will Cygan

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Work Authorization: U.S. Citizen

PROFILE

Senior Software Engineer with 5 years building high-scale commerce and growth systems at LinkedIn — with expertise spanning APIs, relational databases, stream processing, and batch processing.

EXPERIENCE

LinkedIn — *Senior Software Engineer*

Dates: Mar 2024 - Present · Location: Chicago, IL

- Led the design and implementation of a payment-failure alerting platform with near-real-time invoice tracking that recovered \$2M+ annually while operating at 100K read QPS from LinkedIn Feed.
- Extended the payment-failure alerting platform with usage-billing and win-back cancellation-reminder functionality as platform-attributed annual revenue grew from \$2M to \$8M.
- Built a reusable Database cutover library adopted by 10 domain teams for MySQL Migration, using shadow reads, rollback hooks, and TTL-based entity routing to preserve read-after-write consistency.
- Led the 12 TB, 20B-row Ordering migration from Oracle to MySQL, rewriting 30K+ lines of Java & SQL across ~75 PRs while achieving zero downtime and data loss.
- Designed and shipped shared optimistic locking across every MySQL update path, surfacing conflicts before Temporal retries could silently overwrite concurrent writes.
- Built a batch deletion pipeline that safely purged 300K corrupt production orders, then scaled it to purge ~6B dormant orders from a 10+ year-old database.
- Replaced N+1 read patterns with batched MySQL queries across Ordering workflows, reducing average latency from 50 to 30 ms and p95 from 200 to 125 ms.

LinkedIn — *Software Engineer*

Dates: Feb 2022 - Mar 2024 · Location: San Francisco, CA

- Built the video-resolution and Feed integration for a course recommendation service, then scaled it to 3,000 QPS and increased weekly learners 2.5%.
- Designed Spark pipelines that classified 10M+ job seekers across ~50 TB and 20+ datasets per run, expanding personalized alerts to 22M members.
- Scoped and ran an experiment filtering audio-only course recommendations from LinkedIn Feed, increasing engagement 0.2% across hundreds of millions of daily impressions.

LinkedIn — *Software Engineer Intern*

Dates: May 2021 - Aug 2021 · Location: Chicago, IL

Amazon — *Software Engineer Intern*

Dates: May 2020 - Aug 2020 · Location: Chicago, IL

LinkedIn — *Software Engineer Intern*

Dates: Jan 2020 - Apr 2020 · Location: San Francisco, CA

PROJECTS

Anton — *Kubernetes Homelab*

Focus: Kubernetes, GitOps, Self-Hosting · Repository: github.com/wcygan/anton

- Built and operates a three-node bare-metal Kubernetes cluster using Talos Linux and Flux CD.
- Built a GitOps delivery pipeline that validates manifests, publishes container images, records image updates in Git, and deploys releases through Flux.
- Hosts four public applications through Cloudflare Tunnel with HTTPS and no open inbound ports.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Chicago January 2018 - December 2021

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, SQL, Rust, TypeScript, Bash

Infrastructure: gRPC, Temporal, Kafka, Flink, Spark, Airflow, Trino, Kubernetes, Docker

Storage: MySQL, Oracle, SQLite, Redis, DragonflyDB, Couchbase, Venice, OpenSearch, HDFS, S3

AI Tooling: Harness Engineering, Evals, Agentic Coding, Agent Orchestration, Pi, Codex, Claude, Copilot